RudCo
QUOTE DESK

Every line shows its work.

RudCo Quote Desk reads a buyer's messy RFQ and drafts a quote for the rep to check and send. Every field shows the words it came from.

Get Hired Hack, Columbia Startup Lab, October 10, 2026

OUR TRACK

Track 2 | RudCo | RFQ to Quote

The challenge: take a messy RFQ and turn it into a ready-to-send quote. Here is where each ask shows up in Quote Desk.

WHAT THE CHALLENGE ASKS	WHAT QUOTE DESK DOES
Parse each line into a standard spec	Material, grade, form, thickness, size, quantity and standard, each with its source words
Match each line to the catalog	One match, a few candidates with a question, or "No match"
Price against market benchmarks	A price only beside a named, dated benchmark
Flag compliance requirements	MTR, COA, country of origin, DFARS, REACH, RoHS, with trigger words
Ask instead of guess	One clear question to the buyer, with choices

WHY WE BUILT IT

The same item arrives written many ways

```
Buyer A
304 SS sheet 16ga 4x8
Buyer B
Stainless 304, 0.060 in, 48 x 96
```

Both mean a sheet. But 16 gauge is not 0.060 in on a stainless table, and a wrong read becomes a wrong quote, a lost order, or a return.

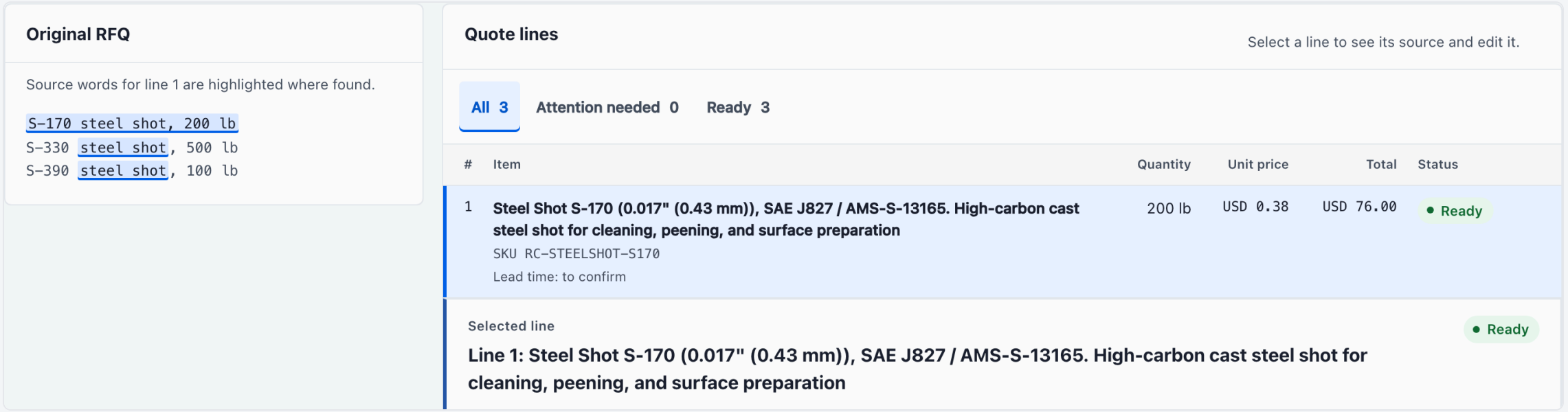
Today a person decodes every line by hand:

Material and grade	304, 304L, 316L
Thickness	A gauge only implies it, and gauge tables differ by material
Size	Inches, feet, either order
Standard	ASTM A240, ASME SA-240
Paperwork	MTR, COA, 3.1 cert, DFARS

RudCo's quote form promises a reply **within 24 hours**. That promise is a requirement in our build.

WHAT WE BUILT

A desk for the quoting rep: the RFQ beside the quote



ACCURATE

Each line read right, matched to what RudCo stocks, with the paperwork the buyer needs.

COMPETITIVE

Each price sits beside a named, dated benchmark, with the reason in one sentence.

FASTER

The rep checks a draft instead of decoding lines. The quote goes out inside 24 hours.

ACCURACY AND UNCERTAINTY

Every field shows its source and its rule

The gauge trap

"16 ga" on stainless reads as 0.0625 in, with the table named. The challenge's own example treats it as 0.060 in.

Thickness **0.0625** Source

> 16 ga

line 12, chars 22–26

16 gauge on the stainless steel table is 0.0625 in (Metal Supermarkets sheet metal gauge chart (tube wall: Wikipedia, Sheet metal)).

No price without a named, dated benchmark

A line with no benchmark is held and left out of the total.

Pricing basis

Price source
RudCo website list price $0.40/lb (https://www.rud-co.com/abrasives/steel-shot), per lb, observed 2026-10-10.

Benchmark
RudCo website list price for RC-STEELSHOT-S330

As of
2026-10-10

Benchmark unit
USD per lb

Compliance flags with trigger words

"SA-240 316L 3/8 plate, with 3.1 cert" raises four flags: ASME code material, 3.1 certificate, MTR and COA. Two are shown.

Paperwork requested

Paperwork requested or implied by the RFQ.

ASME SA code material

> SA-240

The SA prefix means ASME adopted the ASTM spec for Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code use, some grades carry extra ASME requirements, and many mills dual-mark; ask whether the cert must show the SA designation and whether a code stamp or PMI is needed. Research confidence: medium-high as a trigger (Wermac, medium, on the SA vs A detail).

EN 10204 3.1 certificate required

> 3.1

A 3.1 certificate reports test results from the delivered lot, signed by an inspector independent of production; confirm against the buyer's spec, since one research source contradicts itself on who issues it. Research confidence: medium-high. A bare "3.1" could also be a number, so confirm it means the certificate type.

A flag records what the buyer needs. It does not certify RudCo's stock.

ACCURACY AND UNCERTAINTY

Ask instead of guess. The rep approves.

The buyer wrote a thickness that is not a gauge

```
Stainless 304, 0.060 in, 48 x 96, 10 sheets
```

The question that goes out

Line 3 says 0.060 in. 16 gauge stainless is 0.0625 in. Do you need exactly 0.060 in, or is 16 gauge fine?

Questions go out on their own and are tracked on the line. Clear lines keep moving.

The quote shows both readings

OPTION	READING	PRICE
A	16 ga, 0.0625 in	Its own benchmark
B	Exactly 0.060 in	Its own benchmark

The buyer picks one on accepting. Nothing is picked quietly.

STATUS	WHO ACTS NEXT
Ready	The rep approves
Question to send	The rep reviews the question
Waiting on buyer	The buyer answers
No match	Nothing in the catalog fits

The rep approves every quote. Any edit after approval clears it.

HOW IT DIFFERS

What others say on their own pages

WHAT COMPETITORS CLAIM	WHAT QUOTE DESK SHOWS
AI quote tools offer a confidence score (Cassidy) or a low-confidence flag (Proton)	Each field linked to the buyer's words and the table used
Service centers offer mill test reports as downloads after purchase (Central Steel & Wire, Yarde)	Paperwork the spec implies, flagged at quote time
Steel shot makers route quotes to a phone line or contact form (N.T. Ruddock, Winoa)	An emailed steel shot request turned into a draft quote
Proton says it learns a customer's shorthand	A learned reading that says which RFQ confirmed it

Claims are from each company's public pages and were not tested. Sources: docs/research/20261010.03_rudco_competitive_analysis.

TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

Rules decide the facts. The model reads the language.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES HERE
NicrronNinoo	The sponsor model gateway. We call Claude Opus 5 through it to read messy wording into fields
Block Convey	Sponsor resource named by the hackathon
Claude Opus 5	Fills only the fields the rules left empty, quoting the line. It never sets a price
Ruby, Rails 8	The quote app: intake, review, edits, approval, export
SQLite	App storage
Prawn, letter_opener	The quote PDF and the buyer email preview

TEAM

Four people, one owner per part

NAME	ROLE
Ken St. Clair	Product: brief, demo workflow, research, brand and style
Elad Hirsh	App and UI: the Rails app, review screen, approval and export
Yuval Gerber	RFQ processing: text extraction, line reading, flags and buyer questions
Elad Tisch	Catalog, matching and pricing

RudCo
QUOTE DESK

The agent prepares the conversation, and the rep owns it.

Video demo	VIDEO LINK
GitHub	github.com/kenxle/columbia-startup-lab-get-hired-hack